📚 TEACHER REFERENCE

WATER SAFETY RESOURCE DIRECTORY

All organisations, platforms and dry-land teaching resources for Victorian HPE — Year 7–8 and Year 9–10. Fully verified URLs, dry-land applicability notes, and recommended teaching approaches.

🏫 Victorian Schools | 💧 Dry-Land Ready | 📋 Curriculum 2.0 Aligned | 🎯 Year 7–8 & Year 9–10

1 Victorian Government & Curriculum-Aligned Resources

🏛

Victorian Department of Education — Swimming & Water Safety

Government / Policy

Official DE guidance for schools including policy requirements, curriculum alignment, the School Swimming and Water Safety Toolkit, and funding information. Classroom-based learning is explicitly supported and required alongside pool sessions. Mandatory for all Victorian government schools from 2026 under Curriculum 2.0.

https://www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/swimming-instruction-and-water-safety-education/policy

https://www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/swimming-instruction-and-water-safety-education/resources

https://www.education.vic.gov.au/school/teachers/teachingresources/discipline/physed/Pages/swimmingsafety.aspx

✅ Free | 📋 Curriculum-mandated | 💧 Dry-land lessons included | 🏛 Government source

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VCAA — HPE Teaching Resources

Curriculum Authority

The Victorian Curriculum and Assessment Authority provides sample F–10 swimming and water safety activities, achievement standards, and curriculum mapping tools. Includes classroom (land-based) and water-based activity samples. Updated for Version 2.0 from 2025.

https://www.vcaa.vic.edu.au/curriculum/foundation-10/curriculum-area-resources/health-and-physical-education/teaching-resources
https://f10.vcaa.vic.edu.au/health-and-physical-education/curriculum/f-10

✅ Free · 📋 Official curriculum codes · 💧 Classroom activities

Victorian Government — Water Safety Information Hub

Public Information

State government public-facing water safety information including beach safety, inland waterways, multilingual resources, and the BeachSafe link. Excellent for student research tasks and data analysis activities. Updated regularly with seasonal information.

https://www.vic.gov.au/water-safety
https://www.police.vic.gov.au/beach-and-waterways-safety

✅ Free · 📊 Data for student research · 🌐 Multilingual resources

2 Life Saving Victoria (LSV)

Life Saving Victoria — Main Organisation

Peak Body · Victorian

LSV is Victoria's primary aquatic safety organisation. They deliver school programs, publish annual drowning data, provide the School Swimming Toolkit, and work in partnership with VCAA on curriculum development. Their classroom-based resources are free and curriculum-aligned. The LSV Toolkit is the single most useful starting point for Victorian HPE teachers delivering water safety.

https://lsv.com.au
https://lsv.com.au/toolkit
https://lsv.com.au/what-we-do/research-advocacy (annual drowning reports)
https://lsv.com.au/toolkit (curriculum alignment tool)

✅ Free · 💧 Fully dry-land usable · 📋 VCAA-co-developed · 📊 Annual drowning data

🌊 LSV SwimSafe Rules — Key Dry-Land Teaching Content

🪧

Read Signs

Always read warning signs and beach flags before entering any water environment

🧗

Enter Feet First

Never dive into unknown water — submerged objects and shallow depth cause spinal injuries

📏

Stay In Depth

Only swim in water where your feet can touch the bottom, unless you are a confident swimmer

👫

Swim With a Friend

Never swim alone — always have someone with you who can call for help

🙋

Signal For Help

Raise one arm and call out if you need assistance. Stay calm and float to conserve energy

📊

LSV Annual Drowning Reports (2023–24 Key Data)

`Research Data · Annual`

LSV publishes a detailed annual drowning report based on State Coroner data. The 2024–25 report showed 52 fatal drownings in Victoria — below the 2020–21 peak of 64 and the 59 recorded in 2022–23, but 9% above the ten-year average of 48. About 1 in 8 victims were aged 15–24, and ALL deaths occurred at unpatrolled locations. This data is powerful for classroom discussion and numeracy tasks.

https://lsv.com.au/what-we-do/research-advocacy

https://blog.lsv.com.au/2025/07/09/swimming-and-water-safety-in-the-new-victorian-curriculum-f-10-2-0/

✅ Free / Public | 📊 Numeracy cross-curriculum | 💧 Dry-land data activity

3 Royal Life Saving Society Australia (RLSSA)

🏅

Royal Life Saving Society Australia — Swim and Survive

`National Organisation`

RLSSA's Swim and Survive program is Australia's national learn-to-swim and water safety framework. It includes dry-land classroom modules that can be taught independently of pool sessions. The Bronze e-Lifesaving program

(secondary level) addresses risk-taking, peer pressure, alcohol around water, and emergency response — ideal for Year 7–8. RLSSA also publishes the annual National Drowning Report: the 2026 edition recorded 313 drowning deaths in 2025/26, 10% above the ten-year average of 284, at a rate of 1.13 per 100,000. Coastal locations accounted for 151 deaths (48%), inland waterways 90 (29%) and swimming pools 41 (13%). Strong numeracy material.

https://www.royallifesaving.com.au
https://www.drowningprevention.org.au/swimandsurvive
https://www.royallifesaving.com.au/about/contact-us

National framework | 💧 5 classroom modules | 🎓 Bronze e-Lifesaving (Sec)

⚠️ Check cost for modules

4 AUSTSWIM

AUSTSWIM — Australia's Swimming & Water Safety Teaching Body

Teacher Training / Framework

AUSTSWIM provides nationally recognised teacher training in swimming and water safety. Their frameworks and curriculum models are excellent for understanding progression of water safety knowledge and designing dry-land lessons. The "Teacher of Swimming and Water Safety" qualification covers risk management, lesson planning, inclusion, and water safety theory — all usable as dry-land content frameworks.

https://austswim.com.au
https://austswim.com.au/contact-us

📐 Lesson design frameworks | 💧 Dry-land theory content | 🎓 Teacher training

5 Paddle Australia — Inland & Coastal Water Safety

Paddle Australia

National Sport Organisation

Paddle Australia governs canoeing, kayaking, and paddling sports. Critically for Victorian HPE, their safety resources cover rivers, lakes, moving water, and coastal environments — all relevant to the Yarra River, Goulburn River, Port Phillip Bay, and other Victorian waterways. Excellent for a dry-land unit on inland waterway safety, which is where most Victorian drowning deaths occur.

https://paddle.org.au
https://paddle.org.au/contact/

💧 Inland waterway focus | 🏞 Victorian river context | ⛵ Coastal + open water

6 Parks Victoria

Parks Victoria — Open Water & Natural Environment Safety

Government Agency

Parks Victoria manages Victoria's national parks, state parks, and waterways including the Yarra River. Their safety materials cover waterway hazards (currents, submerged objects, cold water, flooding) in natural environments. Excellent for localised scenario-based classroom learning — students can research specific Victorian parks and rivers.

https://www.parks.vic.gov.au

💧 Localised Victorian scenarios | 🌿 Natural environment context | ✅ Free

7 High-Quality International Resources

Royal Life Saving Society UK

International · UK

RLSS UK provides classroom lesson plans, water safety scenarios, and rescue decision-making frameworks suitable for secondary students. Their materials include UK-specific contexts but the concepts translate directly to Victorian settings. Free downloadable classroom resources are available.

https://www.rlss.org.uk
https://www.rlss.org.uk/education

✅ Free resources | 💧 Classroom lessons | 🎭 Scenario-based

American Red Cross — Water Safety Education

International · USA

The Red Cross "Think So You Don't Sink" decision-making model and water safety curriculum includes interactive resources, videos, and home/pool/open water safety lessons. Strong evidence base and excellent for cross-referencing with Australian data. Videos are highly engaging for secondary students.

https://www.redcross.org/take-a-class/water-safety

✅ Free videos | 💧 Decision-making model | 🎬 Engaging for teens

US Centers for Disease Control (CDC) — Drowning Prevention

International · Public Health

The CDC drowning prevention pages provide public health data, risk factor analysis, and prevention research. Excellent for secondary students undertaking data analysis or numeracy-linked tasks. The evidence-base is strong and the statistics can be compared to Australian/Victorian data for higher-order thinking tasks.

https://www.cdc.gov/drowning/prevention

📊 Data analysis tasks | 🏥 Public health lens | 💧 Numeracy cross-curricular

Best-Practice Dry-Land Teaching Approaches

Scenario-Based Learning

Present real or realistic drowning scenarios in Victorian contexts. Students apply knowledge to decide the safest course of action.

- River after rain
- Unpatrolled beach on New Year's Day
- Pool party — unresponsive person
- Rope swing into dam

Role Play & Simulation

Students physically simulate rescue actions in the classroom — no water needed.

- Throw rescue with towels/ropes
- Calling 000 role-play
- DRS ABCD sequencing on mats
- Peer pressure decision scenarios

Hazard Mapping

Students analyse images or maps of waterways, identifying and ranking hazards by risk level.

- Annotated beach images
- River cross-section diagrams
- Pool environment analysis
- Parks Victoria location maps

Data Analysis (Cross-Curricular)

Use LSV drowning data for numeracy activities — percentages, graphs, trends over time.

- Calculate percentage by age group
- Graph 10-year trends
- Compare beach vs inland rates
- Compare Australian vs global data

Decision-Making Models

Teach frameworks that students can apply to any water safety situation:

- LSV SwimSafe rules
- RLSSA risk assessment framework
- Red Cross "Think so you don't sink"
- STOP–THINK–ACT structure

Communication Tasks

Students create water safety materials for real audiences — develops literacy, ICT, and health promotion skills.

- Social media post for teens
- Poster for new migrants (CALD)
- Letter to a younger sibling
- Script for a 30-second radio ad

★ Recommended Resource Combination for Victorian Schools

🏆 "Best Combo" — Core + Enhancement Resources

1

Life Saving Victoria (Core)

Local, curriculum-aligned, practical. Use LSV Toolkit as your primary source. Free and VCAA co-developed.

2

RLSSA — Swim & Survive

Structured classroom modules and Bronze e-Lifesaving for secondary. Strong risk & decision-making content.

3

Victorian DE & VCAA

Curriculum compliance, planning framework, and achievement standards. Essential for documentation.

+

Enhancements

Paddle Australia (inland safety), Red Cross videos (engaging teens), CDC data (numeracy cross-curricular), Parks Vic (Victorian context).

📱

BeachSafe App — Essential Student Resource

Free Surf Life Saving Australia app showing patrolled beaches, patrol hours, conditions, and safety alerts across Victoria. Use as a homework/research task: find the 3 nearest patrolled beaches to your home.

https://beachsafe.org.au

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AIATSIS — Australian Institute of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Studies

First Nations · Cultural Knowledge · Australian Government

Australia's only national institution focused on the study of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander cultures, histories, languages, and futures. The AIATSIS Map of Indigenous Australia is used in this suite to help teachers identify Traditional Custodians of their local waterways — an essential component of the Acknowledgement of Country & Cultural Considerations resource. AIATSIS also holds the most comprehensive collection of First Nations research, literature, and film in Australia.

🗺️ Map of Indigenous Australia · 🌿 Cultural considerations · 📋 Cross-curriculum priority

https://aiatsis.gov.au/explore/map-indigenous-australia

Reconciliation Australia

First Nations · Reconciliation · Schools Resources

Australia's leading reconciliation organisation, providing resources, programs, and guidance for schools, businesses, and community organisations on meaningful reconciliation with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples. Referenced in the Cultural Considerations resource and Teacher Professional Learning Notes as a professional learning pathway for culturally responsive water safety education. The Narragunnawali platform provides free reconciliation planning tools for schools.

🏫 Schools resources · 📚 Narragunnawali platform · 🌿 Cultural competency PL

https://www.reconciliation.org.au/schools/

Australian Resuscitation Council (ARC)

First Aid · CPR Evidence · Clinical Guidelines

Australia's peak body for resuscitation guidelines and clinical evidence. The ARC publishes evidence-based resuscitation guidelines that underpin the CPR content taught throughout this suite — including compression rate (100–120 bpm), depth (5–6cm), ratio (30:2), and the physiological rationale for bystander CPR within 4 minutes. Referenced in the Year 9–10 Extension Workbook as a primary source for the CPR evidence evaluation task (Q2.2) and in the Teacher Professional Learning Notes.

🩺 CPR clinical guidelines · 📊 Bystander CPR evidence · 🏥 Primary source for Q2.2

https://www.resus.org.au/guidelines

Heart Foundation Australia

Cardiac Health · CPR Education · Public Health

The National Heart Foundation of Australia funds cardiac research, advocates for heart health policy, and provides public education on CPR and heart health. Cardiac physiology and CPR rationale referenced in this suite — particularly the Year 9–10 physiology sections explaining cardiac output, heart function, and the physiological basis for CPR — is informed by Heart Foundation evidence. The Heart Foundation's community CPR awareness campaigns complement the water safety CPR content taught in this unit.

💓 Cardiac output explanation | 🏥 CPR physiology | 📚 Year 9–10 physiology section

https://www.heartfoundation.org.au

Consumer Affairs Victoria

Victorian Government · Pool Fencing Legislation · Consumer Protection

The Victorian Government agency responsible for administering consumer protection laws, including residential swimming pool and spa fencing legislation. Victorian legislation mandates four-sided isolation pool fencing for all new residential pools — a requirement with strong evidence for reducing child drowning. Referenced in the Year 9–10 Extension Workbook Q3.2 (policy critique activity) and in the Year 9–10 advanced workbook prevention strategy evaluation section.

⚖️ Pool fencing legislation | 🏊 Home pool safety | 📋 Year 9–10 Extension Q3.2

https://www.consumer.vic.gov.au/housing/swimming-pools-and-spas/fencing

World Bank — Open Data (Country Income Classifications)

International · Development Data · Country Classification

The World Bank Open Data platform provides country income classifications (High / Upper-middle / Lower-middle / Low income) used in the Year 9–10 Extension Workbook Q1.3 (international statistical comparison activity). Students are asked to classify comparison countries by income category to contextualise drowning rate differences — recognising that 92% of global drowning deaths occur in low- and middle-income countries (WHO). World Bank data is licensed CC BY 4.0 and freely available.

📊 Income classification data | 🌍 International comparison | 📋 Year 9–10 Extension Q1.3

https://data.worldbank.org

AUSTSWIM — Australia's Peak Body for Swimming & Water Safety Instruction

`Professional Development · Teacher Qualifications · Swimming Education`

Australia's national peak body for swimming and water safety teaching. AUSTSWIM provides nationally recognised qualifications including the Teacher of Swimming and Water Safety (TSWS) qualification, which directly supports delivery of VC2HP8M01 (Year 7–8) and VC2HP10M01 (Year 9–10). Referenced in the Teacher Professional Learning Notes as the primary qualifications pathway for HPE teachers seeking to build specialist competency in aquatic education. AUSTSWIM also provides professional development, resources, and advocacy for swim teachers across all ages and abilities.

🎓 TSWS qualification | 📚 Teacher PL pathway | 🏊 VC2HP8M01 · VC2HP10M01

https://www.austswim.com.au

Surf Life Saving Australia (SLSA)

`Water Safety · Beach Patrol · BeachSafe App`

Australia's peak coastal water safety organisation, coordinating the volunteer lifesaver network at Australian beaches and managing the BeachSafe app and website (beachsafe.org.au). SLSA produces public education campaigns, beach safety statistics, and training resources. The BeachSafe app referenced throughout this suite as an essential student tool is an SLSA service. Surf Life Saving Victoria (SLSV) is the Victorian branch. SLSA data on patrol hours and rescue statistics supports the Year 9–10 prevention strategy evaluation content.

🏖️ BeachSafe app | 🔴🟡 Red & yellow flags | 📊 Patrol statistics

https://sls.com.au | https://beachsafe.org.au

Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 · HPE · Year 7–8 & Year 9–10 · Water Safety Resource Directory
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